Introduction to videogames

Videogames Technology
Asignatura transversal

Departamento de Automática

Universidad
de Alcalá

Objectives

- Contextualize game development
- Introduce basic vocabulary

Bibliography

1. *Desarrollo de Videojuegos, Arquitectura del Motor de Videojuegos*. UCLM.

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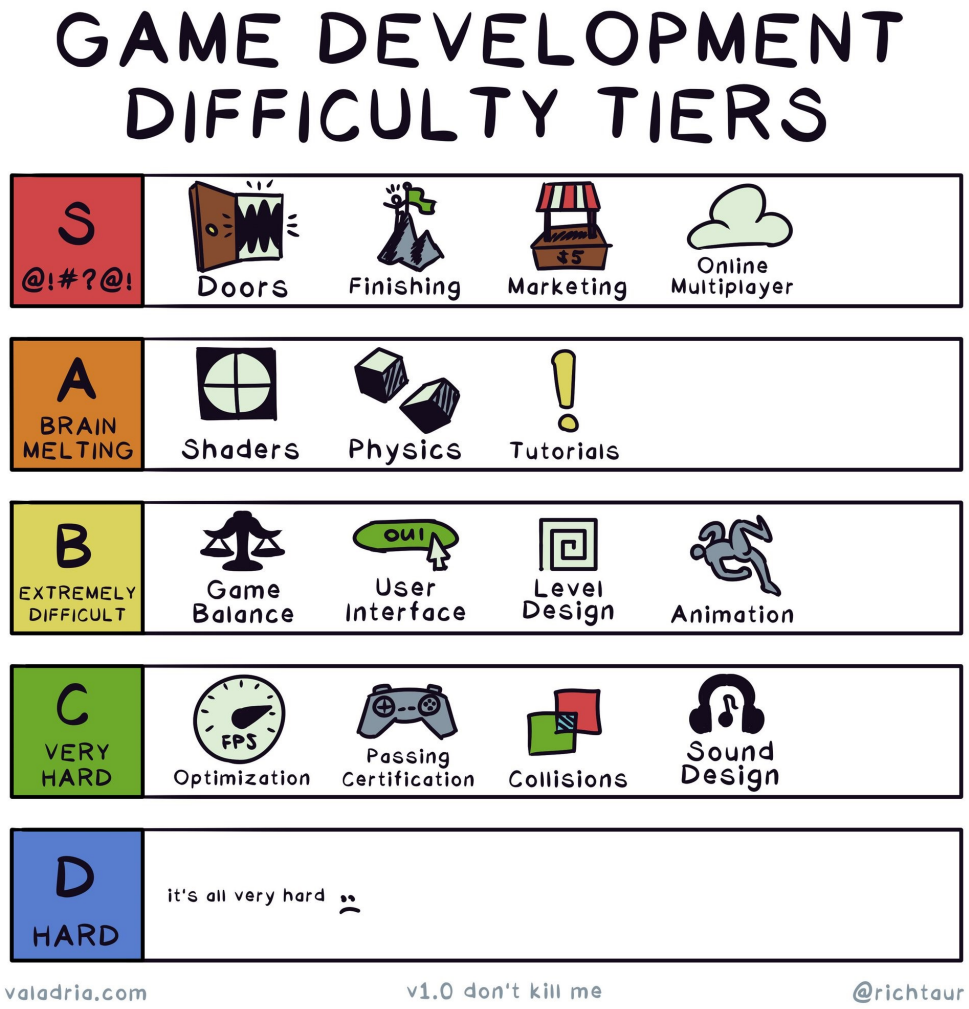
Motivation (I)

Why videogames?

- They involve all the Computer Science disciplines
- Exciting problems from an intelectual perspective
- Benchmark for AI
- Career opportunities
- They are fun!

Motivation (II)



Definition (I)

Vallejo

A videogame is a *graphical application* in *real-time* with an *interaction* between the user and the game

Real-time: **In this context**, it means the need of generating a frame rate
Interaction: Joystick, keyboard, mouse, body, ...

Definition (II)

Alternative definitions:

- A *play activity* with *rules* that involves *conflict* (I. Scheiber)
- A game has "ends and means": an *objective*, an *outcome*, and a *set of rules* to get there (D. Parlett)
- A game is an activity involving *player decisions*, seeking *objectives* within a "limiting context" (i.e. *rules*) (C. Abt)

Game rule = game mechanic

Why a videogame is fun?

- Highly recommended reading: Raph Koster. A Theory of Fun. O'Really, 2nd edition. 2014.

Definition (III)

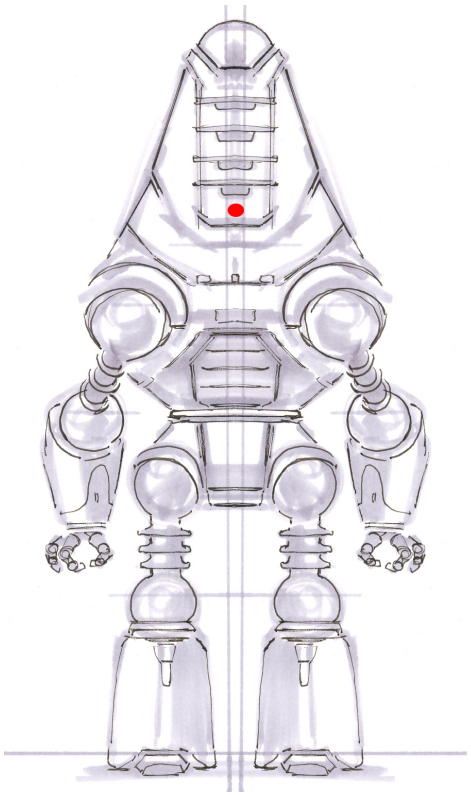
A personal perspective

Videogame = Video + game

Definition (IV)

Elements to take into account

- Story (characters, goals, dialogs, etc)
- Graphics (3D models, animations, videos, etc)
- Sound (Music, sound effects, voice, etc)
- Logic (mechanics, programming, etc)
- Interface (HUD, user interface, etc)
- Gameplay
- Physics



Videogames development

Technical topics

Technical topics involved in videogames development

- Personal computers
- Microprocessors development
- Peripherals (specific for videogames)
- 3D technology
- GPUs
- Computer graphics
- Internet
- Networks
- Videogames engine development
- Physics engines
- Graphical engines
- Software engineering
- Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Videogames development

Other topics

Other topics involved in videogames development:

- Human-machine interfaces
- Social networks
- Mobile technologies
- Tablets
- Cell phones
- Virtual Reality
- Augmented Reality
- Marketing